

ACTIVITIES SECTION

- 1) Keep in mind that your application should present a holistic picture of yourself. That being said, utilize the activities section to talk about a variety of your passions and interests.
- 2) Even though you know which major you're going to pursue, say, Engineering, do not just mention Engineering-oriented activities. Feel free to talk about your involvement in other non-engineering-related areas. For instance, family responsibilities, environmental justice, community service, etc.
- 3) I would advise that if you know your prospective major, then mention your major-related activities first (about 4 of them, that's a good number). But I still stand by my earlier point on diversifying your activities
- 4) Quantify your achievements. This adds a layer of uniqueness to your application. Talk about the number of things that you did, the number of people you oversaw/led, the number of people who attended an event you organised, etc.

Compare these two examples explaining an internship activity:

i) *Interned at Equity Bank Parliament Branch as a corporate teller performing bulk cash transactions and serving high profile clientele*

ii) *Interned at Equity Bank Parliament Branch as a corporate teller. Performed an average of 400 bulk cash transactions a day, exceeding my daily target of 200. Was Employer of the Month twice.*

The second one adds an interesting layer to the activity. It's subtle but it suggests that your productivity is 200%. It shows that you are a hard worker and you exceed your supervisor's expectations. Makes you unique.

- 5) Use action words to describe your activities. Words like: executed, facilitated, participated, commissioned, organised, etc. These words give a lot of "main character" energy, which should show throughout your activities section. Using words like 'helped in doing this' sounds like you were a supporting character in the activity, yet the focus should be on you.
- 6) Talk about the level of recognition of the activity. This could be school level, community level, county level, national, international, etc. This could show your sphere of influence and add a unique layer to your activity.
- 7) Try to show leadership or great teamwork skills. This can be in the action word you use. For example for the leadership you can use: led, commissioned, resolved,

managed, assigned, delegated, facilitated, recruited, organised, etc. For teamwork you can use: collaborated, participated, etc

- 8) You only have about 150 characters- don't be extravagant in your descriptions. Write and rewrite your descriptions until you end up having a very SHORT description that talks about your involvement in the BEST way possible. Know that spaces are also considered as characters for this section, so try your best to reduce them. Look at these two examples:

i) *Interned at Equity Bank Parliament Branch as a corporate teller. Performed an average of 400 bulk cash transactions a day, exceeding my daily target of 200. Was Employer of the Month twice.*

ii) *Interned at Equity Bank Parliament Branch as a corporate teller.Performed an average of 400 bulk cash transactions a day,exceeding my daily target of 200. Was Employer of the Month twice*

The second one saves a few characters by removing the space between the full stop and the letter P, removing the space between the comma and letter e, as well as removing the full stop in the last sentence. This is allowed (but ONLY in the Activities and Honors Sections and NOWHERE else in the application should you EVER bypass ANY grammar rules).